

How to Overcome Fear, Worry, Stress, Anxiety and Depression

TOPIC: FEAR

Q: *What is fear?*

A: Fear is a False Expectation Appearing Real. Fear is an illusion, an imagination of the mind. It is different from a real danger. If there is a tiger in front of you, that is a danger. But if you imagine that you can hear a crocodile and it will kill you when it is just the sound of a lizard, it is fear, a False Expectation Appearing Real. Therefore, we must overcome fear and if we don't, then fear will overcome us.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 14

Q: *Is fear the same as real danger?*

A: Fear is a False Expectation Appearing Real. Fear is an illusion, an imagination of the mind. It is different from a real danger. If there is a tiger in front of you, that is a danger. But if you imagine that you can hear a crocodile and it will kill you when it is just the sound of a lizard, it is fear, a False Expectation Appearing Real.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 14

Q: *Why am I always afraid?*

A: We all Fear. All fears create misery as we live with anxiety that a danger is lurking around the corner. We fear death. We fear loss of love, just as we fear failure in our career. Our life is full of fear when in reality, there is no danger. Fear makes us unhappy and creates misery and sorrow as we anticipate an unpleasant tomorrow.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 14

Q: *What do we fear most in life?*

A: We all Fear. All fears create misery as we live with anxiety that a danger is lurking around the corner. We fear death. We fear loss of love, just as we fear failure in our career. Our life is full of fear when in reality, there is no danger.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 14

Q: *Where does fear come from?*

A: Where does fear come from? Fear comes from thoughts that come from the mind. These thoughts become feelings and ultimately, fear becomes a habit. It becomes natural for us to respond with fear. Even though there is no real danger, we imagine that something will go wrong.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 14

Q: *How does fear become a habit?*

A: Fear comes from thoughts that come from the mind. These thoughts become feelings and ultimately, fear becomes a habit. It becomes natural for us to respond with fear. Even though there is no real danger, we imagine that something will go wrong.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 14

Q: *Why do small fears feel so big?*

A: Fear makes the wolf look much bigger than it is – as the German Proverb says. In fact, there is no wolf but we imagine that the wolf is going to attack us.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 15

Q: *Why do we fear death?*

A: We all fear death but eventually, nobody can escape it. One day, we will die. But we don't realize a simple truth – there are two things that we don't control on earth, our death and our birth. Fear steals our ability to live with faith, for only one of the two emotions can fill our life. We have to choose.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 15

Q: *Can we live in peace if we live in fear?*

A: If we let the disease called fear enter our life, then, we can never live with peace. Remember, those who are diseased by fear, are sure to be deceased by it. Therefore, we must eliminate all fear. We must uproot fear if we want to live a life of peace and bliss.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 15

Q: *Wasn't fear originally a gift?*

A: The emotion of fear was given to us as a special gift to use, whenever there was a danger approaching. It was meant to protect us from real harm. Unfortunately, the mind makes us blind and in ignorance, we let the fear harm us instead.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 15

Q: *Is fear a choice?*

A: The good news is that fear is a choice. If we are wise, we can eliminate fear as we overcome it completely. If only we use our power of discrimination, we can differentiate between an imaginary fear and a real danger. But for this, we must not be caught in thought. We must learn to live in Consciousness.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Pages 15–16

Q: *How can I overcome fear?*

A: Whatever is going to happen will happen. Why must we fear? We must do our best, and then surrender the rest for it to unfold the way it must. We have little choice. We can control our actions, but we have no control on the result thereof. When we live with this acceptance, then fear will disappear. When we learn the art of surrender, then fear will not paralyze us.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 16

Q: *What is the simplest tool to face fear?*

A: 'What is the worst that can happen, and can I deal with it?' This simple statement can then inspire us to do our best. Instead, if we live with fear, then there will be no cheer and enthusiasm and our efforts will be diluted with doubt. We must resolve to eliminate all fear from our life. We must remember that fear is not real. It is just a False Expectation Appearing Real.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 16

Q: *How do faith and acceptance help against fear?*

A: We can control our actions, but we have no control on the result thereof. When we live with this acceptance, then fear will disappear. When we learn the art of surrender, then fear will not paralyze us. Instead, we will let our faith overtake our hope and then cope with any fear that tries to appear. We must learn to replace what we expect with being able to accept whatever happens without protest.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 16

Q: *Why do phobias take over our life?*

A: Shilpa lived with fear. She feared many things. She had a phobia for spiders and if she saw one, she would scream in terror. Her fears became paranoia. For instance, even before the dentist could start her treatment, she would begin to scream. Her life was filled with the toxic emotion of fear. She lacked faith, courage, confidence and thus lived with stress and anxiety. Was there any danger? No! It was just fear.

Source: Chapter 3 – Fear, Page 14

TOPIC 2: WORRY

Q: *What is worry?*

A: What is Worry? It is... W – Waste of Life, O – Overthinking, R – Repeating the Fear, R – Rehearsing the Problem, Y – Yearning of the Mind. Although we realize that it is meaningless to worry, we continue to worry!

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 17

Q: *What does the word WORRY stand for?*

A: What is Worry? It is... W – Waste of Life, O – Overthinking, R – Repeating the Fear, R – Rehearsing the Problem, Y – Yearning of the Mind.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 17

Q: *What does worry do to our life?*

A: What does worry do? Because of our negative, toxic thoughts, we lose the treasure of our present moment. Instead of enjoying today, we jump to a yesterday that is gone, and then to a

tomorrow not yet born. Worry steals our greatest gift – the present.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 17

Q: *Is there ever a real need to worry?*

A: Actually, there is no need to worry. If there is no problem, then why should we worry? Even if there is a problem, we shouldn't worry because if we can do something about the problem, then we don't need to worry. And if we can't do anything, then what is the point of worrying!

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 17

Q: *How does worry destroy a celebration called life?*

A: Very few people master the monster called worry. Worry is a beast! It robs us of the feast called life. Life is a celebration but worry makes us live in desperation. It creates fear, stress and anxiety. Ultimately, we can sink into depression.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 17

Q: *If worry is meaningless, why do we still worry?*

A: Although we know that worrying is meaningless, why do we worry? Worry is created by the mind, a mind that we cannot find! Still, some thoughts pour like rain and make us worry, again and again. Thoughts of worry drill us and kill us, and we submit to these thoughts as if we are helpless.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Pages 17–18

Q: *How can I live a life with no worry?*

A: If we want to live a life that has no worry, we can. We have to find peace of mind. But when there is a mind, peace we cannot find! There will be worry and we will never enjoy our curry! If we want to live our life without this strife, then we have to still the mind. Then, peace we will find.

Worry exists nowhere, except in the mind.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 18

Q: *Where does worry actually exist?*

A: Worry exists nowhere, except in the mind. But when we realize that there is no mind, then there will be no worry.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 18

Q: *Can worry become a habit?*

A: Ram used to worry a lot. He had many businesses, but his life was full of worry. He worried about cash flow, just as he worried about the tax departments troubling him. His worry didn't stop there. He worried about his children's education and their career. He worried about his health. In fact, Ram had made worrying a habit. It seemed as though he was enjoying worrying when in reality, worry was consuming him.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 18

Q: *Do we control what happens to us?*

A: One day, he realized that it was pointless to worry because he met an intelligent friend who advised him that he was losing his peace and happiness to – worry. He explained how we have no control over what will happen. What we have control over is our reaction.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 18

Q: *What is the difference between reacting and responding?*

A: We can choose – either we can live with RDX, React Destroy eXplode or we can live with RDR, we can choose to Respond, rather than React. The solution is to accept the fact – whatever will be will be. We cannot change what will happen, but we have full control on our reaction. We can

worry and waste our life by overthinking, or we can peacefully accept and do our best.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 18

Q: *How does worry amplify the problem?*

A: What does worry do? It Repeats the fear and Rehearses the problem. Just like a television announces a disaster a hundred times, so does worry amplify the problem and this aggression leads to depression. Instead, the wise ones learn to simplify the problem. They put the problem

in proper perspective as they move from a state of mind to a state of intellect. When we discriminate, there is really no worry.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Pages 18–19

Q: Does greed and desire create worry?

A: Sometimes, it is our yearning, our desires and our passion that create needless worry. Instead of living with fulfilment, being satisfied with our need, we let greed overtake us and then, we worry and lose our peace and happiness. Of what use then, is this worry if it stops us from living with a smile!

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 19

Q: Can I stop overthinking?

A: The good news is that we can overcome worry. We can stop this overthinking, this rehearsing and repeating of negative thoughts that replay in our mind again and again. We can replace negative emotions with positive emotions and as we flip over, we will experience optimism instead of pessimism. It is a choice.

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 19

Q: How do I replace pessimism with optimism?

A: We can replace negative emotions with positive emotions and as we flip over, we will experience optimism instead of pessimism. It is a choice. We can worry and waste our life or live with faith, courage and confidence and eliminate misery and strife. So, you can either worry or enjoy your curry!

Source: Chapter 4 – Worry, Page 19

TOPIC 3: STRESS

Q: Why must we overcome stress?

A: Why must we overcome stress? Because stress makes our life a mess! It robs our peace and bliss, and we land in unhappiness. In fact, stress is a combination of fear and worry, and leads to anxiety and depression. These are a series of joy stealers. They are messengers of misery, and we must uproot them from our life.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 20

Q: What causes us to feel stressed out?

A: Don't you feel stressed out? Why? It is because the mind is drilling you and killing you with toxic, negative, poisonous thoughts. You don't get stressed out with happy thoughts. When you are joyous, there is no stress and when you are stressed out, you just can't be happy.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 20

Q: What exactly happens to us under stress?

A: Stress is a state of extreme worry, a state of fear and phobia. What happens next? We begin to sweat, even shiver, as we lose control of our life.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 20

Q: What does the word STRESS stand for?

A: What is stress made of? Look at the word S T R E S S carefully. It is a combination of, S – Sad thoughts, T – Toxic thoughts, R – Repetitive thoughts, E – Exhausting thoughts, S – Suffocating thoughts and S – Sadistic thoughts. When all our thoughts are poisonous, how can our life be joyous?

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 20

Q: How do we take charge of our stress?

A: When we take charge of our life, then we take charge of our thoughts. We still our mind. Then, the mind ceases to exist. So does stress. It disappears.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 20

Q: Why do small daily things stress us so much?

A: Radha was always stressed. She was stressed about her maid servant, whether she would come or not, whether she would cook or not and whether she would clean or not. Then, she was stressed about her work, how she would complete her tasks. She was stressed about

people around and what they thought about her or spoke about her. She was stressed about her performance, her career, her growth.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 21

Q: *How does stress steal our life?*

A: Radha's stress was never ending and therefore, she was always stressed out. She had no time to live. All her time was spent in worry and fear. She was nervous about everything. This robbed her of her confidence and courage. It affected her efficiency and stole her peace and joy. Is this the way to live?

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 21

Q: *Is stress really just negative thinking?*

A: Many of us are like Radha. Our life is filled with stress. What does it mean? It means our life is filled with toxic thoughts. Stress is nothing but a product of negative thinking. As long as we are pessimists and remain slaves of the mind, in thought we will be caught, and stress will steal our happiness.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 21

Q: *How common is stress today?*

A: Stress is not a rare disorder. In fact, it has become a very common disease, even more common than a cough and cold, because it is prevalent in our day-to-day life. Many people have stress for breakfast, lunch and dinner. If they don't have a meal of stress, they become hungry for it. Stress becomes a habit. But once we let stress occupy our mind and life, we lose control of our bliss.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 21

Q: *Is stress about thoughts?*

A: It's all about thought. As long as we have control of our thinking, there will be no stress. When thoughts pour like rain, they push us down the drain. We imagine fears and we rehearse problems. We create fictitious dangers and needlessly become nervous and anxious.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 22

Q: *Why can't I discriminate when I'm stressed?*

A: If only the intellect could discriminate stressful thoughts, there would be no stress. But unfortunately, when stress envelops us, the intellect is deactivated. We become puppets and are controlled by strings of negative thoughts, and we dance to the tunes of our mind's music.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 22

Q: *What is the way out of stress?*

A: What is the way out of stress? How can we get out of this mess? It is quite simple. It is realizing the cause. It is our own mind, a mind that we cannot find. It is our own thoughts, thoughts in which we are caught and so, we forget that stress is nothing but negative, fictitious and imaginary thinking. It is not real! If we overcome the mind, and its toxic thoughts, we will automatically overcome stress.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 22

Q: *Is stress real?*

A: Stress is nothing but negative, fictitious and imaginary thinking. It is not real! If we overcome the mind, and its toxic thoughts, we will automatically overcome stress.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 22

Q: *Why do I feel helpless when I am stressed?*

A: Alas, those of us who are slaves of stress feel helpless as stress rules our life. It creates a storm and steals our calm. It robs us of our tranquillity as it creates so much anxiety.

Source: Chapter 5 – Stress, Page 22

Q: *How is stress connected to anxiety and depression?*

A: In fact, stress is a combination of fear and worry, and leads to anxiety and depression. These are a series of joy stealers. They are messengers of misery, and we must uproot them from our life.

TOPIC 4: ANXIETY

Q: What causes anxiety?

A: What is the cause of Anxiety? It is our own mind. It steals our tranquillity. Any one of these two emotions can fill our head. We can have peace, the very foundation of happiness or we can have stress and anxiety till we are dead. It's a choice.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 23

Q: Can anxiety become a habit?

A: If we choose to be anxious, then anxiety will become a habit, a way of life. We all will experience an occasional spell of anxiety. But if we learn the art of overcoming it, then, we will be blessed to live with serenity.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 23

Q: What is anxiety made of?

A: Anxiety is a combination of fear, worry, stress and can be triggered by regret, shame and guilt. It can cause depression. What are the signs of anxiety? There are many. It can even lead to shivering and sweating, as we imagine the worst.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 23

Q: How does anxiety erupt inside us?

A: Anxiety erupts like a volcano. It is silent but destroys everything. It has fumes of stress and sparks of fear and ultimately paralyzes our ability to discriminate as we become slaves to our own thoughts.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 23

Q: Is anxiety real or imagined?

A: Anxiety is not a reality. It is an imagination of the mind. We become anxious either because of something that doesn't exist, or because we worry about a situation that we can do nothing about.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 23

Q: Why can't I think clearly when I am anxious?

A: When there is anxiety, we deprive ourselves of the ability to act wisely and sensibly for we lose our Consciousness to rotten thoughts that drive us to a state where discrimination is not possible. Instead, if we are calm and still our mind, without being anxious, we can live with courage and confidence and make the right decision as to what we must do.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Pages 23–24

Q: What does anxiety stop us from doing?

A: Anxiety stops us from thinking of a solution to the problem. Instead, it makes us worry, repeatedly bombarding us with fear and drilling us with the problem. It makes us imagine the worst that can happen and steals our bliss and joy.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 24

Q: How can I replace anxiety with tranquillity?

A: Therefore, we must overcome anxiety. We must replace it with that state of tranquillity where there is peace. For this, we have to take charge of our thoughts. We have to still the mind. We have to put a filter so that negative thoughts don't flow like a gushing river and destroy our life.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 24

Q: What does an anxiety attack look like?

A: Shyam would tremble because of the anxiety that would overwhelm him. He would feel helpless as he remained anxious of the many fears and dangers that he imagined. It would make him feel so uneasy that his restlessness was obvious. The doctors warned Shyam that anxiety was affecting his health, his blood pressure and even his heart.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 24

Q: Why do I make a mountain out of a molehill?

A: Anxiety had caught Shyam by the hook. He used to sweat and react to every situation as if a bomb was about to explode. He would make a mountain out of a molehill and was unable to

deal with his anxiety. Shyam would frequently worry, and his intense excessive, persistent anxiety appeared even in very simple situations. He would experience panic attacks, and he would cry and withdraw from everybody.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 24

Q: Does anxiety affect those around me too?

A: They let anxiety reach a point where it is uncontrollable and it causes constant distress. Not only does it affect the person who is anxious but it also vibrates to everybody around them.

Wouldn't we like to choose tranquillity and peace, rather than fear, worry, stress and anxiety?

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 25

Q: What are simple things I can do when anxiety strikes?

A: Some people who are attacked by anxiety, withdraw into silence. Either they listen to a positive song or watch a comedy or sometimes, go over to a friend who can give them some positivity. Whether it is reading an inspirational book or just meditating, there are simple methods that can reduce anxiety. Even a long walk or exercise can take our mind away, just as some good music can be a solution.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 25

Q: Is there really such a thing as peace of mind?

A: However, if we want to overcome anxiety, we have to learn what causes it. It is our own mind that appears to be king, which causes all suffering. We talk of peace of mind when in reality, there can be no peace when the mind is there. Unless we still it, and we kill it, we cannot be in that state of Consciousness where the intellect wipes out anxiety through simple discrimination. In Consciousness, anxiety is replaced by tranquillity.

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 25

Q: Can blaming Karma make anxiety worse?

A: Shyam questioned, 'What can I do? There is so much tension at work. There are problems I can't solve. Nothing seems to be working right! I seem to be under a spell of bad luck. Is it my bad Karma that is beyond my control?'

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 24

Q: Why must I overcome anxiety?

A: Shouldn't we learn the art of wiping anxiety out of our life? Shouldn't we be free of anger that bursts because we are anxious? Should we worry about everything that is happening around us and feel neglected and dejected in every situation? How can one live with anxiety?

Source: Chapter 6 – Anxiety, Page 25

TOPIC 5: DEPRESSION

Q: What is depression?

A: What is Depression? It is said to be a mental illness. It is a state of being depressed, feeling sad and completely empty. But in reality, depression is not emptiness. It is an aggression of thoughts, negative, toxic thoughts that lead one to a state of descending into a valley of gloom.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 26

Q: Why do we slip from sadness into depression?

A: If we live with fear, worry, stress and anxiety, there is still hope that we will not fall into the state called depression. But when the mind knocks us out, defeats us, kills us, we may still be physically alive, but mentally we are dead. There is poison in our head. It seems we have become a zombie, who lives without meaning and purpose.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 26

Q: When does sadness become depression?

A: Our life becomes directionless as we swing from one bad mood to another. We all experience moments of depression, but when we reach that state of being depressed all the time, we label it as depression.

Q: What is the root cause of depression?

A: How to overcome depression? We must understand the root cause of depression. It is the mind — a mind that we cannot find! But still, the thoughts that attack us, imprison us behind bars of depression.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 26

Q: Why does depression feel like defeat?

A: In depression, thoughts don't knock at our door. They silently bombard us, and we are knocked out on the floor. We are unable to push them out and shut the door because we are in a state of depression. We have acknowledged defeat. We have given over the reins of our life to the mind.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 26

Q: How does the mind ride us in depression?

A: There was once a man who was riding a horse. Somebody asked him, 'Where are you going?' He replied, 'I don't know. Ask the horse!' Depression is that state that stops us from being the boss. The mind rides our life horse. The mind makes us a slave and the misery of depression remains with us till we reach our grave.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 27

Q: Can I get out of depression?

A: But there is good news. We can overcome depression. We can snap out from this low of sorrow to a high of tomorrow by taking charge of the present moment and filling it with positive thoughts. We can make a U-turn from the sorrow of depression to the joy of celebration. This is possible if only we realize how to do it.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 27

Q: Should I rely only on psychiatrists for depression?

A: Some people go to a psychiatrist. They consider depression to be a mental illness. They are prescribed drugs and tranquilizers and even take hormonal treatments to improve their mental health. They are diagnosed as being bi-polar and then medicated to help them come out of depression. Is this necessary? It is a choice. When the disease has to do with the mind, we can find a way out of it through two effective ways... But if we resort to going to the psychiatrist, then we will never get to the root of depression and overcome it.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 27

Q: What is the first way to overcome depression?

A: The first way to deal with depression is to flip over from negative thoughts to positive thoughts. Depression is caused by toxic thoughts like fear, worry, stress, anxiety, regret, shame, guilt and even anger, hate, revenge and jealousy. When our life is filled with these poisonous thoughts, we will continue to be in a state of depression.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 27

Q: Which positive thoughts can replace toxic ones?

A: If we take charge of our mind, flush out these toxic thoughts, and instead choose to live with faith, hope, trust, enthusiasm, love, compassion, forgiveness, courage, confidence and optimism, we can fill our life and energize it to wipe out the gloom of depression. For this, we have to take charge of our thoughts, our feelings, our attitude. We have to become the boss and not let the mind ride our horse. We can wipe out depression.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Pages 27–28

Q: What is the second, deeper way to overcome depression?

A: The second route, which is more effective, is going beyond just flipping over from the negative to the positive. It is moving from a state of mind to a state of Consciousness. This is a state of thoughtlessness, even called mindfulness. We still the mind and thus, kill the mind. It is the mind that produces negative, toxic thoughts. When there is no mind, no toxic thought, where is the question of depression?

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 28

Q: *Why does it feel so hard to climb out of depression?*

A: It is possible. But it is not easy because the mind will fight hard to stop us from going into Consciousness because once we live with awareness, the mind is dead, and the mind fights very hard to bombard us with thoughts and keep us suppressed in depression.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 28

Q: *Is depression a disease or a disorder?*

A: It is a choice whether we want to give up our life and let the mind make it a mess, or overcome all toxic thoughts and live with joy, peace, love and happiness. Depression is a disorder, not a disease.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 28

Q: *What is depression really feeding on?*

A: Depression is Hopelessness, living with a Bad Mood. The Cause is Toxic Thoughts that become our Mind's Food!

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 28

Q: *Does depression make me feel like a zombie?*

A: When the mind knocks us out, defeats us, kills us, we may still be physically alive, but mentally we are dead. There is poison in our head. It seems we have become a zombie, who lives without meaning and purpose. Our life becomes directionless as we swing from one bad mood to another.

Source: Chapter 7 – Depression, Page 26

TOPIC 6: THE MIND

Q: *What is the main cause of all my suffering?*

A: While we suffer physical pain, the root cause of all suffering is the Mind. Along with the Ego, it becomes the ME that does not permit us to be free from suffering. Even the thought of the ego seems to emerge from the mind, although the ego is a separate demon.

Source: Chapter 2 – The Main Cause Of Suffering, Page 11

Q: *How are my thoughts shaping my destiny?*

A: Our life is rooted in our thoughts. Thoughts create feelings. These feelings create actions and actions become habits that build our character. Ultimately, this leads to our destiny. Therefore, just like the seeds that we plant are responsible for the fruit on the tree, it is the thoughts that we plant that become deeds and are responsible for our destiny.

Source: Chapter 2 – The Main Cause Of Suffering, Page 11

Q: *Where do thoughts come from?*

A: Thoughts seem to appear from what we call the mind. The mind is like a Thought Factory. It constantly pops thoughts. Just like a popcorn machine, our mind is capable of producing a new thought, every second. This can become a whopping 50,000 thoughts a day!

Source: Chapter 2 – The Main Cause Of Suffering, Page 11

Q: *Does the mind torment us even in sleep?*

A: Not only does the mind create misery when we are awake, it does not even spare us when we sleep. It creates nightmares that make us jump out of our bed, imagining that we are dead. Such a rascal is our mind! But the funny thing is – Where is the mind? We cannot find!

Source: Chapter 2 – The Main Cause Of Suffering, Page 11

Q: *Has anyone ever seen the mind?*

A: Have you ever seen the mind? No... What is the shape of the mind? What colour is the mind and what is its size? Has anyone seen the mind? No. Nobody in this world has seen the mind. Those who go on a quest to find the mind realize that the mind, we cannot find! Still, it makes us blind. It hides behind the bone and skin and creates all the misery within.

Source: Chapter 2 – The Main Cause Of Suffering, Page 12

Q: How can something invisible cause real suffering?

A: While nobody has seen the mind, how is it possible that the mind can cause all our suffering? Are these emotions of fear, worry, stress, anxiety and depression just our imagination? Of course not! We see people cry till they die, as they experience this pain and it repeats, again and again.

Source: Chapter 2 – The Main Cause Of Suffering, Page 12

Q: What does the word MIND stand for?

A: What is the Mind? Look carefully and you will agree that the M I N D is, M – Misery, I – Ignorance, N – Negativity, D – Desire. This is the essence of the mind and appears in its acronym.

Source: Chapter 8 – Root Cause Of Our 5 Miseries, Pages 29–30

Q: Will the mind by default produce negative thoughts?

A: Do we choose our thoughts? If we don't live in Consciousness, then we are not the master of our mind. The mind is like a thought factory. It is like a popcorn machine. It is constantly producing thoughts. It can produce 50 thoughts in a minute. By default, the mind will only produce negative thoughts. Sometimes, it fools us. It makes us believe that the mind is king. But what is the truth? The mind is the cause of all suffering.

Source: Chapter 8 – Root Cause Of Our 5 Miseries, Page 29

Q: Is the mind really the king of my life?

A: The mind is a rascal. In reality, it does not exist. Still, it causes all our suffering because it appears to be the king of our life. It makes us believe that we cannot live without it. Have you even imagined how life would be without the mind and its thoughts? The mind fools us into believing that it is the intellect too. It bombards us with negative thoughts and imprisons us behind bars of ignorance.

Source: Chapter 10 – The Mind Is Not King, Page 36

Q: Why do we wrongly try to befriend the mind?

A: Unfortunately, because we don't realize that it is the mind that is our biggest enemy, we try to befriend it. In fact, we try to use the mind to overcome our depression, when the mind itself is the real cause of it.

Source: Chapter 10 – The Mind Is Not King, Page 36

Q: How does the mind trick us as the "king"?

A: The mind is not king. It is the cause of suffering. By default, the mind makes us suffer again and again with thoughts that pour like rain and push us down the drain. It is the mind that is causing fear, making False Expectations Appearing Real. It is the mind that is making us worry, repeating our fears and problems and overthinking. With its thoughts, the mind is drilling us and killing us, causing stress and making our life a mess.

Source: Chapter 10 – The Mind Is Not King, Page 37

Q: What happened when a king tried to find his mind?

A: The next day, when the king met the saint, the first thing the saint asked was, 'Have you brought your mind?' The king, a little irritated, replied, 'How could I come here without my mind?' The wise man smiled and said... 'sit in the next room and get hold of your mind which is carrying your fear, worry, stress and anxiety. Once you give me your mind, I promise I will remove all of the misery and poison that is in it.' Saying this, he left the king to contemplate. The king started to ponder, 'Where is my mind?' He could not find the mind.

Source: Chapter 10 – The Mind Is Not King, Page 35

Q: What is the truth about the mind's existence?

A: The king realized that there is no mind. These were just thoughts that were causing fear and worry, stress and anxiety. The mind appears to be, but actually it has no existence. The saint had opened the king's eyes to realize this truth.

Source: Chapter 10 – The Mind Is Not King, Page 36

Q: How can I kill the mind?

A: Only those who master the mind and catch it, they can kill it! The method prescribed to kill the mind is, first watch it, then catch it, then latch it. Those who don't understand the mind, are

confused. I can watch it, but how can I catch it and latch it? If only we learn that the way to catch the mind is to still it, then we can ultimately kill it!

Source: Chapter 13 – How Can We Kill The Mind?, Page 44

Q: *What is the relationship between mind and thoughts?*

A: The mind is nothing but a bundle of thoughts. When thoughts don't pour like rain, then, there is no pain because there is no mind. We can still the mind and make it disappear, but we can never completely stop thoughts from appearing in our head till we are dead. If only we take charge of our thoughts and let them be filtered by our intellect, then in that state of Consciousness, we can succeed in putting the mind behind bars.

Source: Chapter 8 – Root Cause Of Our 5 Miseries, Page 30

TOPIC 7: TOXIC THOUGHTS & CONSCIOUSNESS

Q: *What is the cause of all my suffering in one line?*

A: Suffering is caused by the mind, a mind that you cannot find. But still, it leaves our peace and joy behind. It bombards us with thoughts and then we are caught. There is fear, worry, stress, anxiety and more. Regret, shame and guilt knock at our door and then, we are on the floor! There is depression because of the aggression caused by thoughts.

Source: Chapter 9 – Toxic Thoughts Make Us Miserable, Page 32

Q: *Can I stop thinking entirely?*

A: For us to live, we have to breathe. There is no option. So also, every human being who is alive must think. But we have a choice. We can let toxic thoughts fill our life and create strife, or we can let happy thoughts create joy and optimism. By default, we are bombarded by the negative thoughts of the mind.

Source: Chapter 9 – Toxic Thoughts Make Us Miserable, Page 32

Q: *What is NEP and what is PEP?*

A: We can call this NEP. NEP is Negative Energy that causes Poison. Negative thoughts like anger, hate, revenge, jealousy, pessimism, doubt, despair, shame, guilt and regret, all these create the diseases of fear, worry, stress, anxiety and depression. These come as a package... If we want to be free from toxic thoughts that make us miserable, then we have to flip over from NEP to PEP.

Source: Chapter 9 – Toxic Thoughts Make Us Miserable, Page 32

Q: *What positive thoughts should I fill my mind with?*

A: We have to fill our mind with positive thoughts like faith, hope, belief, trust, enthusiasm, courage, confidence, compassion, forgiveness, optimism, joy, cheer, enthusiasm and the likes. These positive thoughts will wipe out the negative thoughts that are making us miserable.

source: Chapter 9 – Toxic Thoughts Make Us Miserable, Pages 32–33

Q: *How do toxic thoughts actually make me miserable?*

A: How do toxic thoughts make us miserable? These poisonous thoughts create negative feelings and a bad mood. Once we have created this aura, then we need no effort to be unhappy. We automatically descend into a valley of gloom and depression, as our toxic thoughts rule our life.

Source: Chapter 9 – Toxic Thoughts Make Us Miserable, Page 33

Q: *Why must I accept what has already happened?*

A: Whenever there is misery in life, we must not wonder why. There is no need to cry. We must realize that it is toxic thoughts that are making us miserable. If something has happened, we have to learn to accept it. If we are worrying about something that may happen, we have to stop this negative thinking as it only causes stress and anxiety.

Source: Chapter 9 – Toxic Thoughts Make Us Miserable, Page 34

Q: *Is being sad really a choice?*

A: All forms of toxic thoughts are sure to steal our bliss and create unhappiness. If only there are no toxic thoughts, we can be blissful and peaceful, and this is a choice. If we can be glad, but if we choose to be sad, then we are mad!

Source: Chapter 9 – Toxic Thoughts Make Us Miserable, Page 34

Q: *Is it possible to change my thoughts?*

A: Since thoughts are so deadly, and they cause so much suffering and can even lead us to suicide, what can we do to our thoughts? Is it possible to stop thinking? We can meditate and contemplate and slow down our thoughts, but we can't entirely stop thoughts from emerging in our head till the moment we are dead. While we can't stop thoughts, we can change them.

Source: Chapter 12 – How Can We Change Our Thoughts?, Page 41

Q: *What raw material does the mind feed on?*

A: The mind is like a popcorn machine. It is constantly popping thoughts. But we can control what we put into the mind. Just like you will get caramel popcorn or salted popcorn based on what you feed the corn machine, so also, our thoughts depend on what we feed the 'Mind Machine'. The raw material for the mind, our thought factory, is emotion. If we feed the mind negative emotions, it will produce negative thoughts. But if we fill the mind with positive emotions, we can think and react positively.

Source: Chapter 12 – How Can We Change Our Thoughts?, Page 41

Q: *What emotions make the mind toxic?*

A: Just imagine, feeding the mind with emotions like regret, shame, guilt, pessimism, fear, worry, stress, anxiety, anger, hate, revenge and jealousy. What kind of thoughts do you think the mind will produce? There is no doubt that the 'Mind Machine' will be full of toxic thoughts.

Source: Chapter 12 – How Can We Change Our Thoughts?, Page 41

Q: *What seeds should I plant in my mind?*

A: But if we clean the 'Machine' that produces thoughts, and now feed it with seeds like faith and hope, trust and enthusiasm, courage and confidence, love and compassion, optimism and forgiveness, then the raw material that we feed automatically changes what pops out of the mind. There will be positive thoughts.

Source: Chapter 12 – How Can We Change Our Thoughts?, Page 41

Q: *What happens if I do nothing about my mind?*

A: There is an important revelation that we are unaware of. If we do not constantly feed the mind with positive raw material, by default, it will produce negative thoughts. Such is the mind, the rascal that we cannot find!

Source: Chapter 12 – How Can We Change Our Thoughts?, Page 42

Q: *What is Consciousness?*

A: How can we flip over from mind to Consciousness? Consciousness is the state of thoughtlessness. It is also referred to as mindfulness or awareness. It is that state when the mind that is gushing like a river with thoughts is made to stop by building a dam.

Source: Chapter 12 – How Can We Change Our Thoughts?, Page 42

Q: *How does Consciousness change my thoughts?*

A: In this state of Consciousness, where thoughts don't pour like rain, creating poison again and again, the intellect will discriminate each thought, one by one, as it gently appears in our Consciousness. In this state of discrimination, we can intercept a thought and change it. Normally, thoughts of the mind are like a bulldozer. They rush past us and become feelings and actions. But if we are in Consciousness, with the intellect in charge, we can discriminate and change our thoughts.

Source: Chapter 12 – How Can We Change Our Thoughts?, Pages 42–43

Q: *What are the two ways to change my thoughts?*

A: Putting it together, there are two known ways to change thoughts. We can move from negative to positive, just as we can move from mind to Consciousness. Then, we can become the master of the mind and we can live as a monk, as we cut the tail of the Monkey Mind, the EY of the MONKEY that is Ever-Yelling and Ever-Yearning.

Source: Chapter 12 – How Can We Change Our Thoughts?, Page 43

TOPIC 8: SUFFERING, SUICIDE & LIBERATION

Q: Why do all human beings suffer?

A: Every creature who is born on earth, suffers. We human beings experience pain of the body, misery of the mind and agony of the ego. Nobody can escape this. From the time we are born, we fall as we grow tall and experience all kinds of aches and pains. One day, this body will die but before that, it is sure to experience a variety of diseases as it decays.

Source: Chapter 1 – The Triple Suffering, Page 8

Q: *What is the triple suffering?*

A: More than the physical pain, which can be dealt with medication and a variety of treatments, is the misery of the mind. The mind creates fear, worry, stress, anxiety, regret, shame, guilt, depression and many more states that can destroy us... Apart from physical pain and mental illnesses, we have a third suffering. It is the anguish of the ego. The ego creates anger, hate, revenge and jealousy.

Source: Chapter 1 – The Triple Suffering, Page 8

Q: *What is "Rotten-thought-itis"?*

A: All these disorders are more serious than physical ailments like tuberculosis, hepatitis or viral infections. They are caused because of Rotten-thought-itis – a mental illness that emerges because of toxic, rotten thoughts. The mind creates so much misery and sorrow that it robs our present moment. It robs our 'today' as it swings us into a 'yesterday' and a 'tomorrow'.

Source: Chapter 1 – The Triple Suffering, Page 8

Q: *Is there any escape from this suffering?*

A: Here is some good news. We, human beings, are the only ones who are truly blessed. We can be liberated from all misery on earth and from rebirth. If only we realize the truth that we are not the body, mind and ego, we can be free from all misery. This is the goal - to realize that we are the Divine Soul.

Source: Chapter 1 – The Triple Suffering, Page 9

Q: *What are the two big questions of life?*

A: But some people go on a quest. They discover As to the two most important questions of life: • Who am I? • Why am I here? They are the ones who overcome all trauma because they realize the truth of this drama called life.

Source: Chapter 1 – The Triple Suffering, Page 9

Q: *Why hasn't medicine solved mental illness?*

A: However, the world is struggling to find solutions to mental illnesses. Psychiatrists around the world are treating mental disorders but unfortunately, they are able to treat the brain and solve the pain that has to do with the bone and skin but they have not learned how to deal with the mind that is the devil within. The mind is a rascal. It appears as king but in reality, it is the cause of all suffering.

Source: Chapter 1 – The Triple Suffering, Page 10

Q: *What pushes a person toward suicide?*

A: While we can understand how fears can create phobia, and how worries can rob our bliss, how stress can create a mess and anxiety can destroy our tranquillity, it is very difficult to comprehend how depression can cause suicide. Let us analyze. The mind thinks up to 50 thoughts a minute. As it bombards us with these aggressive thoughts, it first creates stress and anxiety.

Thereafter, it causes a greater damage. It makes us withdraw into depression.

Source: Chapter 11 – What Causes Suicide?, Page 38

Q: *How does the mind defeat our intellect?*

A: What is this depression all about? In this state, we are overpowered by the mind. It seems like we have lost our defence mechanism that can protect us from toxic thoughts. What actually happens is that the monster mind steals our Consciousness and with it, our ability to discriminate, which is a gift bestowed on the intellect. We human beings are blessed with this

power that can discriminate black from white, wrong from right. When the mind overpowers us, it destroys our intelligence and ability to choose.

Source: Chapter 11 – What Causes Suicide?, Page 38

Q: *Why does the mind magnify our problems?*

A: We all have problems, who doesn't? But the mind makes a mountain out of a molehill! It makes the wolf look bigger than it is. It magnifies our fears and anxieties and confronts us with thoughts like, 'How will I be able to face this problem? What if this or that were to happen to me?' The mind drills us so badly that it kills the intellect and leads us to that moment called suicide. Then, it is game over!

Source: Chapter 11 – What Causes Suicide?, Pages 38–39

Q: *Why do rich and successful people commit suicide?*

A: What causes us to end our life? Although this gift of life is so precious, why do so many happy, successful, rich people end their life? It is because of the mind. The mind puts all the good

things behind, and it continues to play the miseries in our head, again and again, till we take some drastic step, and we are dead.

Source: Chapter 11 – What Causes Suicide?, Page 40

Q: *Is suicide ever logical?*

A: Suicide is very often the cause of a rotten thought that germinates into a toxic decision and leads to the irrevocable action of ending life. Is there any logic to this? No! This tragic end is caused by our mind, a mind that makes us fear and worry and causes so much anxiety that we lose our peace and tranquillity. And thus, having lost the power to discriminate, we decide to terminate this precious gift called Life.

Source: Chapter 11 – What Causes Suicide?, Page 40

Q: *Isn't it time to destroy the destroyer within?*

A: Isn't it time to destroy our mind, the one that destroys our peace and our bliss, our joy and our happiness and ultimately, destroys our life itself?

Source: Chapter 11 – What Causes Suicide?, Page 40

Q: *Can I really live with no fear, no stress, no anxiety?*

A: There is a way to overcome fear. There is a way to 'worry no more'. We can replace Stress with Happiness and Anxiety with Tranquillity. We can stop the Aggression of the mind that causes Depression. All we have to do is get to the root. Then, these poisonous fruits will not shoot into our life. We need to find the cause because these are just effects. Once we eliminate the cause, these mental disorders will disappear from our life.

Source: Preface, Page 5

Q: *What is the universal truth about suffering?*

A: This is the universal truth. It doesn't depend on our nationality or religion. Every human being suffers because of the mind and if we don't unwind the mind, and slow down its pace, it will continue to race, and we will be caught in the maze of misery and sorrow.

Source: Chapter 8 – Root Cause Of Our 5 Miseries, Page 31

Q: *How do I finally live in peace and tranquillity?*

A: All our miseries are because of the mind and its thoughts. This is the root cause of all the evil that explodes in our life. If only we realize the root cause, we can be free from the effects of fear, worry, stress, anxiety and depression. We can be liberated from pain and anxiety and fill our life with peace and tranquillity. There is a way to live with Eternal Bliss, a way to seamless

Happiness. However, for this, we have to eliminate the toxic thoughts of the mind.

Source: Chapter 2 – The Main Cause Of Suffering, Page 13